

Mail

on the release of Bt brinjal unless it is proved free of toxins.
IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR,
Srikakulam

Ample scientific evidence now exists to prove that GM crops have harmful effects. What India needs is an independent biotech regulatory body insulated from the hypnotising commercial interests of multinationals and an internationally accepted, transparent, accountable protocol for biosafety trials. Genetic engineering might be a powerful technology, but a reckless embrace of genetically modified crops without any transparency about the process of clearance, various biosafety tests and long-term feeding studies is a recipe for certain disaster.

VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bathinda*

Caste Away

The fulminations of Kancha Ilaiah seem time barred ("Angst of the Outcaste", February 22). The nation today is being ruled mostly by the so-called lowest denominational castes. The southern states like Tamil Nadu have literally eliminated Brahmins from every field. An incredible social revolution has taken place in the last 60-odd years in India, silently and successfully, without a trace of violence. M.

Karunanidhi and Mayawati, the most articulate critics of Manuvad, find themselves in prime positions elected in a Brahminical Hindu milieu. In Hindu religious ambience, there is room for every one because tolerance is its chief asset. Ilaiah can very well direct his angst against corruption, misrule and political exploitation in this country rather write hate books and

taken, the days are not very far when the tiger would only be seen in zoological parks. It's a matter of shame that in a country of more than 100 crore people, we cannot formulate a national policy on animal conservation.

LT-COL (RETD) RANJIT SINHA,
Kochi

Quota Dangers

There should not be any reservation for minorities



VIVAN MEHRA/www.indiatodayimages.com

Low-cost carriers have been able to understand the major needs of the customers—reliability and value for money. Thanks to such carriers, air travel is no more the privilege of the upper classes.

BHUSHAN CHANDER JINDAL, *Jalandhar*

provoke the gullible.
T. SANTHANAM,
via www.indiatoday.in

Saving Big Cats

It is unfortunate that not much interest has been shown by the states towards the implementation of various proposals sent by the National Tiger Conservation Authority on saving tigers ("The Memory Hole", February 22). Unless utmost care is

either in educational institutions or anywhere else ("Quota Conundrum", February 22). Quotas are politicians' tool and help nobody but them. Reservations have adverse effects as inefficient people get jobs rather easily and this causes deterioration in quality of services. Hence reservations should not be permitted.

MAHESH KAPASI,
via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MAY 1-15, 1980

One-Man Industry

At any given time of day, over one lakh people are watching a tall, lanky, slightly gawky figure sing, dance and especially fight on the screen.

Every year, approximately four crore people crowd the cinemas to watch this man battle the forces of evil, and it has been estimated that one in every six Indians has seen one of his films. Each time he leaves his elegant house in Bombay's Juhu-Ville Parle scheme, investments worth Rs 50 crore ride on him. So much in demand is the dark, taciturn star that the hordes of eager producers who queue up outside his dressing rooms are told that they cannot expect shooting dates before early 1983. And yet, the offers keep on coming. As French producers Alain Chamas who tried unsuccessfully to sign him for *Crossings* opposite Jon Voight and Richard Dreyfus finally remarked in sheer exasperation: "This man is not just a star. Amitabh Bachchan is an industry."

by Vir Sanghvi with Zothanpari Hrahsel and Surender Bhatia



AMITABH
BACHCHAN

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